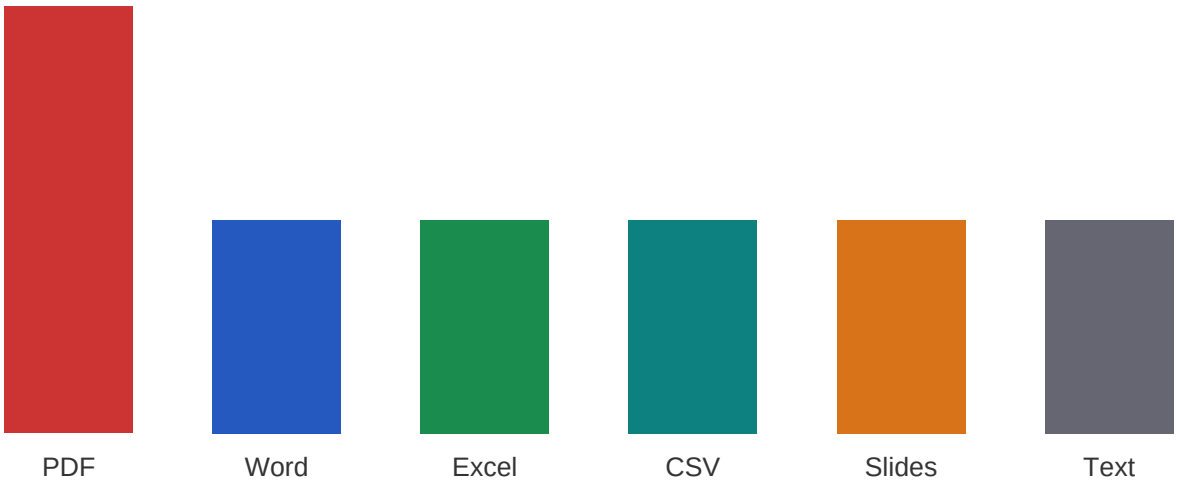
# Reading documents in Flutter

A short guide to universal_document_viewer

## Chapter 1: What it reads

Six kinds of document, read by engines that ship inside the package. The chart below shows how many of the sample files are in each format.




Flutter website (a web link)

# Chapter 2

## Opening a document

One widget, DocumentViewer.file(path), picks the right reader from the file name. PDF, Word, Excel, CSV, PowerPoint and plain text all open the same way, and a typed error says why a file could not be read: too large, damaged, protected by a password or not a supported kind of file.

Excel workbooks and CSV files open in a lazy grid that builds only the cells on screen. Column widths, frozen panes, merged cells, number formats, borders, conditional formatting and notes come from the file itself.

PowerPoint decks show one slide at a time with their titles, text, tables and pictures, and a bar to move between slides.

Every reader can search. Matches are highlighted and you can step through them one by one; a scanned PDF without a text layer is detected so the app can say why nothing was found.

Each reader reports its position as a small JSON-safe map. Store it however you like, pass it back as initialPosition, and the document reopens on the same page, slide, row or line.

DocumentThumbnails renders a PNG of any document, and of the page a saved position resumes on, so a library screen can show where each file was left.

Office files are checked before they are parsed. Damaged archives, paths that try to leave the archive and oversized contents are refused instead of filling memory.

When the ready-made viewer is not enough, use the controller and view for one format and build your own app bar, search field and page indicator around them.

Android, iOS, macOS, Windows and Linux. The engines are part of the package, so there is no other document plugin or web view to add.

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Pages are drawn by PDFium and built only near the viewport. Each page starts as a small image and is sharpened with tiles as you zoom in, so a long report stays smooth on a modest phone. Pinch, double-tap or use the mouse wheel to zoom.

# Chapter 3

## Reading PDF

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# Chapter 4

## Reading Word

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# Chapter 5

## Reading spreadsheets

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# Chapter 6

## Reading slides

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# Chapter 7

## Searching

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# Chapter 8

## Resuming where you left off

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## Thumbnails

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# Chapter 11

## Your own interface

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